

Chapter 85-4

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Xu Qingzhu's words had hidden meanings, as if she was playing riddles with her.

Liang Shi didn't understand, but Xu Qingzhu refused to say more, telling her there was no need to overthink it. Right now there was a pile of messes in front of them—they should deal with Qi Jiao's matter first.

As soon as she thought of Qi Jiao, Liang Shi's thoughts were diverted.

What could now be confirmed was that Qi Jiao was Gu Xingyue, and Liang Shi's speculation was largely correct.

Yang Jiani held leverage over the former Director Gu and used it to threaten Gu Xingyue, then made Gu Xingyue act as Qi Jiao's stand-in for all these years.

And the former Director Gu had once seen Yang Jiani abuse Gu Xingyue but was powerless to do anything. So after returning to the orphanage, she was consumed by guilt and eventually went insane.

After Liang Shi told Xu Qingzhu all this information, Xu Qingzhu shook her head helplessly: "Now we can only wait for Gu Xingyue to figure things out. She's the most crucial person."

"Yes." Liang Shi said: "If you want others to save you, you have to save yourself first."

"But after going through so many years, even the strongest person would have been tamed. How could she possibly still have thoughts of resistance?" Xu Qingzhu sighed. "In a family like that, both Qi Jiao and Gu Xingyue are so pitiful."

"Yes." Liang Shi suddenly recalled the Qi Jiao she had seen in the dark dream and couldn't help but feel emotional. "When Qi Jiao was little, she was really like a little angel. I don't understand why Yang Jiani would treat her that way."

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu raised her eyebrows slightly. "Hm? How was she like a little angel?"

Liang Shi paused for a moment, then told Xu Qingzhu about everything she had seen in that dream.

She said that Qi Jiao would secretly hide little cookies for her, would comfort her not to be afraid, would shield her when Yang Jiani hit her, and would go act cute and kiss Yang Jiani after Yang Jiani suffered domestic violence.

In summary, young Qi Jiao was very similar to Ling Dang now, but also had a hint of Rainbow's calm temperament mixed in.

After hearing this, Xu Qingzhu suddenly said: "If that's the case, then Yang Jiani killed the person who loved her most in this world with her own hands."

Listening to this, a tear suddenly fell from Liang Shi's eye.

Even she herself was startled.

"You seem to really like her." Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi first shook her head, then nodded: "I don't seem to have many memories of spending time with her, but whenever I can remember, I feel very sad."

Especially since she was now looking at it from an adult's perspective.

Young Qi Jiao should have been at an age of carefree abandon, just like Ling Dang, but Qi Jiao had to comfort an unrelated little sister, console her beaten mother, and her own body was covered in injuries.

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment. "It is quite sad."

After that, she didn't say anything more.

The two still had an appointment to keep that evening. On the way back, Xu Qingzhu curled up in the passenger seat and took a nap.

Liang Shi played some soft music to help her sleep. The car drove all the way from the outskirts back to the city.

They first returned to the apartment. The moment Liang Shi pushed open the door, she saw the living room piled full of stuff.

Xu Qingzhu stood behind her, watching her with a leisurely expression that seemed to say—See? Look at what you did.

Liang Shi awkwardly rubbed her nose. "Let's do our makeup and change clothes first. If there's time when we get back tonight, I'll tidy up. If not, I'll do it tomorrow. Just bear with it for now."

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "That's the only option."

Then the two went back to their respective rooms, but two seconds later, they both came out at the same time, looking at each other and asking the same question: "Do you want to shower first or should I?"

The bathroom here wasn't like at Repulse Bay where there were multiple ones—it was a shared bathroom.

So they had to take turns using it.

Liang Shi said: "You go first. I'll unpack and assemble the vanity tables."

Xu Qingzhu didn't stand on ceremony either. Time didn't allow them to dawdle.

Liang Shi's past life experience made her adept at these things. She quickly assembled the two identical vanity tables and put them in their respective rooms.

There was still time afterward, so she also unpacked the newly purchased furniture one by one and put them in Xu Qingzhu's bedroom. Her own bedroom just gained a vanity table.

After finishing, she also organized the cardboard boxes on the floor and swept the floor while she was at it.

When Xu Qingzhu came out after her shower, she discovered that the living room had suddenly become clean.

She was surprised: "You finished everything?"

Liang Shi nodded: "...Yes."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"It just looked like a lot." Liang Shi said: "There actually wasn't that much. I put everything directly in your room. If there's anything missing, we can add more."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She was impressed by Liang Shi's efficiency.

While Xu Qingzhu was doing her makeup, Liang Shi went to the bathroom to shower.

Xu Qingzhu had just finished showering, and the bathroom was still misty with steam. Upon entering, one could still smell the crisp scent of oranges—the smell of her shampoo.

Liang Shi glanced around and noticed that the shampoo, conditioner, and body wash on the shelf were all neatly arranged and from the same product line.

Her own bottles had basically been emptied before, so she hadn't brought them when she left Repulse Bay. She had originally planned to buy new ones after moving to the new place, but she had forgotten that day too. She poked her head out of the bathroom and asked: "Teacher Xu, can I use your shampoo and body wash?"

Xu Qingzhu answered: "Yes."

Liang Shi: "Okay, thank you."

She was being polite to the extreme.

After saying this, she closed the bathroom door. Xu Qingzhu, who was in her room applying body lotion, paused her movements for a moment. Her palm glided over her fair leg, spreading out a large dollop of white lotion. Her gaze swept toward the bathroom, and then she set aside her body lotion that was running low and didn't use any more.

Even though she hadn't applied any to her other leg yet.

What was left should be enough for one person. She'd leave it for Liang Shi, Xu Qingzhu thought.